

The Earth Wind and Fire Experience By Al McKay

Production Info Handbook

Dear,

I took the time to put all the info regarding a production day for our fantastic band, in this manual. Please take the time to read it, understand and execute it. If you do so, all of us will have a great day.

Share this information with Stage Manager, Sound, Light, video, backline, dressing room, transportation,... crew chiefs.

Huge tanks in advance,

Hilko

Production and Stage manager

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Start of the day:

Pickup at the hotel EWFE Crew.

Be on time!

We travel from the hotel to the venue with some cases, make sure they fit in the vehicle.

If it's a long drive, supply some water to drink during the drive.

Upon arrival of the EWFE Crew at the Venue:

- Make sure there are cold beverages, snacks and some hot sandwiches or burgers or kebabs available for our crew (3-4 persons)

- **The PA and Monitor system are up and running.**

Please check all the wireless equipment (belt packs for the; Horn Players, percussion, keyboard players , etc.) . Make sure the four horn-mics, wireless mics for singers, inear belt-packs are working correctly and ready to go. Etc. etc.

Make sure the guys from the sound company speak and understand English.

I need one person with my FOH engineer at all times! He speaks and understand English AND he knows the PA system, desk, etc.

I need one person with my Monitor engineer at all times! He speaks and understand English AND he knows the monitor system, desk, wireless etc.

In other words the system engineers stay with my engineers all the time.

Check the input and output lists (technical rider attached).

Make sure the communication between FOH and Monitor is up and running. My engineers have to be able to communicate with each other.

- **The Risers and Backline are built.**

Make sure the risers are build and in position. If you're not sure, don't hesitate to contact me by phone or email.

- Make sure the backline is all setup. I would like to see a backline ready to go, all powered up. Drum kit and percussion can be build "in the rough", the musicians will come in and adjust. NOTE: if there is no support act or we don't have to move the percussion, we don't need a rolling riser. We build the percussion on the floor! If we have to move the percussion (festivals) we need a rolling riser, so make sure it has wheels. (Backline list and stage plot attached)

- The FOH engineer, Monitor engineer and myself will check the equipment. I'll re-adjust risers and backline if needed.

Make sure there are no Front Fill speakers laying on stage! Place them on stands or on cases in-front of the stage, place them at least one foot lower, measured from the top of stage floor to

the top of the speaker.

- Keep the stage clean! Not only we expect a cleaned stage to work on, free of dust, tape, etc. Also keep the floor cabling tight and effective.
No cables should run over the stage, no cables downstage (front of the stage), I don't want my singers to trip over them! Run the monitor cables for the downstage wedges off the stage (in front of the stage) and tape them securely into place after we decided on their position.
All other cables, run them clean and effective, not in the way of our musicians. We love proper cable management, nobody likes tripping over cables.
There has to be secure railings around the stage.
The risers for our Horn Players, Drummer and Keyboard player 2 need steps. In fact the horn players riser needs stairs or a step in front of the riser and one in the back.
The edge of the stage has to be marked with white or fluorescent tape.
The stage floor has to be sturdy/not moving

Upon arrival of the musicians.

- The Drummer, Percussionist and keyboard players will arrive first.
If for some reason the equipment is not up and running, I will delay the arrival of the musicians. This probably results in holding the doors. We don't want that!
So please respect the agreed time tables. Make sure all the equipment is there, up and running on arrival of the crew.
- Make sure the dressing rooms are ready the latest 15min before arrival of the first band members.
Mario Kriegl, our Tour Manager will set the time tables.
There should be 3 Dressing rooms labeled: Singers, Band and Horns.
 - Singers (3-4 persons) as close as possible to the stage and restrooms, please no stairs.
 - Band (6 persons + 3 crew)
 - Horns (4 persons)If there is a forth room available, we'll use it as a production/crew room (3 persons)
Make sure the dressing rooms and restrooms are clean and safe.
- The local backline crew has to be present upon musicians arrival. Our drummer needs a hand adjusting his drum kit, the same for our percussion and keyboard players. Make sure you have a cleaning towel for our Keyboard player #2. Also we will need to tape stuff down with proper high quality gaff tape (if you supply us with sticky stuff, the backline and cabling will suffer from this)

Linecheck

- We'll start the line check when everything is: up and running/working like it should.
- A quick "tap check" to see if all the lines are working correctly.
- The monitor engineer will check the 3 singers wireless mics with the FOH engineer.
Make sure you have **3 round base straight stands** for our singers mics. No, tripod mic stands will **NOT** work.
- **Festivals, line check**
We like to line check our full backline behind the backdrop before our show. Make sure you have cables ready to power the backline and connect to the stage boxes so we can check the lines with our monitor engineer BEFORE we do a changeover.

More band members arrive

- After line check, more band members arrive, guitarist and bass player will set up their gear and will check the amps. Obviously the rental backline crew is here to assist whenever necessary.

- Bass reminder:
 - Make sure the tweeters are working in the bass cabinets! Supply fuses for the horns.
 - Have two speakon cables ready to hookup the two 4x10" cabinets + power cable for the bass amp
 - We need high quality 1/4" jack to jack cables 2x 6m 2x 1,5m
- Guitar Reminder:
 - we need a 110v converter next to the amp. Do not plug any personal equipment into power sockets!

Soundcheck.

- Have light on stage, please, during our soundcheck we need light. Don't have the LD programming lights during our soundcheck.
- We start with our rhythm section; drummer, bassist, keys, ... start playing their instruments one by one. During that time we'll set/adjust monitor levels, etc.
- Once all the musicians are on stage we play a few bars of a track and dial-in balances.
- When everyone is happy we end the soundcheck. We try to keep soundcheck's as short as possible. Do mind, we sometimes have to run trough a couple of songs. Any missing or nonfunctional piece of equipment will result in later and/or longer soundcheck times. Which results in holding doors, we don't want that!
- Please no Smoking on or around the stage!

Lights

We don't travel with a LD, so we use a local one.

Some requirements they need to know:

- No SMOKE, HAZE, FOGG,.. during our show! DO NOT run a hazer or smoke machine whenever there are band members in the venue.
- No green lights, it makes us look like zombies.
- No crazy/fast flashing lights.
- No strobe lights.
- No dark stage in-between songs
- Percussion, Drummer, keyboard player one and keyboard player two stay in the same position all the time
- Singers, they move/dance a lot all over the stage.
- Guitarist, bass player and horns move position, from time to time they come downstage.
- If you have two follow spots, GREAT!
- Whenever there is a solo, please give them some attention/accentuate it with light.
- Did I mention: No SMOKE, HAZE, FOGG,.. during our show! DO NOT run a hazer or smoke machine whenever there are band members in the venue.
- I can supply the LD with a setlist, just ask me.
- When the show is over, the band comes forward to salute. Put lights on the audience please so the band can see them.

Video

If there is a video wall behind the musicians, great!

We start our show with a video.

Also we have a graphic you can use.

Please don't project crazy/intense flashing things on the screens.

Keep it sober and style-full.

Dinner/Hotel

Depending on what Mario Kriegl our TM arranged we stay at the venue or go back to the hotel.

The Show

Mario Kriegl, our TM will gather the band together and will bring them to the side of the stage. Also he will sign our engineers to start the show.

No announcement before the show. We have our own introduction tape/video.

We can't start the show if we don't have our stage water and towels.

36x 0,5l still room temperature water

20x Hand Towels (MAX size: 50x100cm Minimum Size 40x60cm)

During the day we have to print 20 setlists and tape them town in position.

I can use a hand taping down the setlists, placing the water and towels before the show starts.

Stage Left wing we like to have 3 bar stools.

Also stage left wing I like to have a working surface (can be a flightcase) with a towel, guitar tuner, a light and some basic tools to re-string a guitar or bass during the show.

Stage manager and Rental backline crew is present during the show.

Backline crew keeps an eye on the equipment. If something fails, they can assist me.

When the show is over make sure the band can get to the dressing rooms uninterrupted.

After the show

The musicians will break down their personal equipment. Give them some light so they see what they do and don't forget anything.

Please give us a hand to bring the cases back to the dressing rooms and transportation vehicles.

There will be Pizza's, cold beers/white wine for artists and touring crew.

We say goodbye and thank you, we travel back to the hotel.

Make sure the transportation can get to the dressing rooms or as close as possible.

Transportations has to be on time, every time.

Additional notes:

If you like to thank the production manager. Please note I like cold dry white wine. Chardonnay, Pinot Grigio and Verdejo are grapes I really appreciate. Liking the white wine to be unoaked. Chablis is always a great choice!